APMC was sought to be increased to the entire state and traders' licences were to be converted into pan-state licences. These reforms were carried out by some states, but remained more on paper. As the regulatory regime and fee structure remained the same in every mandi, it made no difference to the farmer. The monopolistic character of APMCs remained unaffected even in the states where the Model APMC Act, 2003, was legislated.

Some more choices were offered to farmers. Farmers' markets could be established in addition to APMCs. Contract farming was allowed to enable farmers to enter into direct contracts with processors. However, it is difficult for farmers to set up markets as they do not have the resources, time and ability to do so. Contract farming contracts were very highly regulated. Again, the result was not encouraging. Only a limited number of farmers' markets were set up in seventeen years of these market reforms and a negligible number of contracts were registered under the contract farming facility.

Though exemptions were provided in some states on horticulture products, the mandi fee regime essentially remained intact. In effect, mandi fees generate very small resources these days to take care of market infrastructure. Most market infrastructure in the past two decades has been constructed under central schemes like RKVY, the Market Infrastructure Scheme, Warehousing Scheme of Food Corporation of India (FCI), and the like.

The APMC reforms of the past two decades did not address the principal flaws in agriculture produce marketing: the absence of competitive markets; a one-size-fits-all approach of overregulation of markets implemented in a decentralized manner by organized vested interests; lack of standardization and aggregation of farmers' produce; leasing of land not being legally permitted; and exclusion of processors and wholesalers on account of storage restrictions. Consequently, the APMC reforms did not make much of a difference.